

Mike Lyons

Engineering Leader

Email | mdl0394@gmail.com
City | San Francisco
Site | https://MikeLyons.org/
Github | https://github.com/frenchie4111

Physical Intelligence,

My name is Mike. I'm a lifelong software engineer with a not-so-secret passion for hardware.

I've spent a majority of my career working on the backend/firmware/ML systems that bring hardware to life. These days I am particularly excited about figuring out how to enable edge hardware to be as smart as our cloud software has gotten.

I'm definitely a product-oriented engineer, so I am a great fit as π starts to offer its product to the world.

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EXPERIENCE

hi finance
CTO / Co-Founder
May 2025 - Present

- Lead engineering as co-founder. Built a custom **agent harness and software factory** that writes and ships its own code. Built a company that helps students get grants. We helped >4,000 students earn more than $4m in grant funding.

Stealth Startup
CTO / Co-Founder
Mar 2024 - May 2025

- Co-founded a pre-seed startup and raised **$2.5M** with the goal of modernizing the HVAC controls industry by deploying AI/ML stacks on the edge

Verkada
Head of Software, Intercom
2021 - Dec 2023

- Built & Led the Software team **(8 engineers)** that shipped the Intercom product line. Required mastery of **cameras, WebRTC (audio/video)** and access control. Launched as Verkada's most successful new product line (9 months to ship, sold $14m in the first year)
- Before that: Led the team to rebuild the Access Control product line's firmware/backend to shift **control logic & inference to the edge compute devices**

Dor Technologies
Pre-Seed → Series A (Exited)
Head of AI/ML
Cofounder
2015 - 2021

- Founding engineer, later hiring, mentoring, and leading the **AI/ML team** as it grew to 10
- Responsible for the **sensor-fusion based algorithms** that powered our battery-powered IoT device for tracking customer foot traffic
- Built a **camera powered data collection device and the supporting data pipelines for labeling data & retraining models**

Mark One / MyVessyl
Software Engineer
2014 – 2015

- Designed and built the backend infrastructure behind an **AI-driven consumer hardware device**.

Apple
Software Engineering Co-op
2013 - 2014

- Worked on the Mobile Device Management (MDM) protocol, the interface that millions of Apple customers use to manage fleets of Apple devices

Earlier

- Technical Cofounder at CareerLabs (2015 – 2016). Software engineering intern at InstallNet & Aertight Systems, Annapolis MD (2011 – 2012).

OPEN SOURCE

Ness
Creator & Primary Author
Open Source | 2026 - Present

- An open-source IDE for coding with agents: parallel agent sessions across git worktrees, each with its own terminal, shell, and a browser the agent drives directly.